

Reining in Online Gaming Platforms

‘The Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Bill, 2025’ is a balancing act between **safeguarding** the gamers while restricting gaming companies to **go berserk**

It was long **overdue**, and finally the Government has **woken up** to the need for regulating online gaming sites, something **many**, especially youth, **are addicted to** and have lost lakhs of rupees to these gaming sites. **Reportedly**, many youth **committed** suicide after losing large amounts of money on these portals, one boy even **self-immolated** after losing a big amount. To **curb** this **menace** the Lok Sabha has passed ‘The Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Bill, 2025’, which defines India’s approach to its fast-growing digital gaming industry. Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology Ashwini Vaishnaw, presented the bill in the Lok Sabha which was cleared without debate. The bill aims to **strike a delicate balance** — encouraging e-sports, casual gaming, and educational platforms on one hand, while banning real-money gaming and online betting on the other. The online gaming sector in India has grown rapidly, **thanks to** cheap data, smartphone availability, and the popularity of sports leagues. The industry is **projected** to be worth \$3.6 billion by 2029. However, this growth has come with troubling side effects. Concerns have also been raised about **addiction**, **financial distress**, **money laundering**, **tax evasion**, and even the use of gaming platforms for financing terrorist activities. **Against this backdrop**, the bill **seeks** to provide a legal and regulatory framework that safeguards consumers while allowing e-sports and social gaming to **flourish**. The key **provisions** of the Bill **include** banning real-money gaming. Offering or **facilitating** online money gaming will be punishable by up to three years in prison and/or a fine of Rs 1 crore. Besides, now there would be advertising restrictions and financial controls **in place**.

Though **a step in the right direction**, Online Gaming Bill is **by no means foolproof** and carries several **lacunae** that raise concerns about its **effectiveness**. The legislation **imposes** a **blanket** ban on real-money gaming without **drawing a clear line** between games of skill and games of chance. **Moreover**, while the bill seeks to **address** addiction, it **falls short of** introducing responsible gaming frameworks such as age checks, spending limits, or **rehabilitation mechanisms**, opting instead for **prohibition**. Additionally, the bill does not clearly define the role or powers of a regulator for e-sports and casual gaming, leaving uncertainty over **enforcement**, nor does it **account for emerging** technologies like blockchain, NFTs, and metaverse-based gaming. In its current form, **the bill**, though **well-intentioned**, **risks** being both **vague** and incomplete, potentially creating economic **disruption**, and **enforcement** challenges. A more effective **way forward** would be for the government to adopt a balanced regulatory framework rather than a **sweeping** ban. The law should clearly **distinguish** between games of skill and games of chance, as courts have **often** done, and create licensing **norms** for responsible operators. A strong, independent regulator with defined powers could **oversee compliance**, curb illegal platforms, and ensure **coordination** between the Centre and states and deal with gaming platforms effectively.

[Practice Exercise]

Vocabulary

1. **Rein in** (phrasal verb) – restrain, curb, control, rein back, check नियंत्रण करना
2. **Safeguard** (verb) – protect, secure, shield, defend, preserve संरक्षण करना
3. **Go berserk** (phrase) – run amok, go wild, lose control, go haywire, rampage बेकाबू हो जाना
4. **Overdue** (adjective) – belated, long-delayed, late, pending, behindhand लंबित
5. **Wake up** (phrasal verb) – become alert, take notice, realize, act, take cognizance सचेत होना
6. **Addict** (to) (verb) – habituate, hook, enslave, engross, condition आदी बनाना
7. **Reportedly** (adverb) – allegedly, supposedly, by reports, as stated, said to be कथित रूप से
8. **Commit** (verb) – perpetrate, carry out, execute, perform, undertake अंजाम देना
9. **Self-immolate** (verb) – burn oneself, set oneself ablaze, immolate oneself, self-burn, self-sacrifice by fire आत्मदाह करना
10. **Curb** (verb) – restrict, limit, contain, clamp down on, rein in रोकना
11. **Menace** (noun) – threat, danger, scourge, nuisance, peril खतरा
12. **Strike a balance** (phrase) – find middle ground, reconcile interests, calibrate, balance out, achieve equilibrium संतुलन साधना
13. **Delicate** (adjective) – sensitive, fine, fragile, nuanced, tricky नाजुक
14. **Thanks to** (phrase) – due to, because of, owing to, on account of, attributable to की बदौलत
15. **Project** (verb) – estimate, forecast, predict, envisage, anticipate अनुमान लगाना
16. **Addiction** (noun) – dependence, habit, compulsion, craving, dependency लत
17. **Financial stress** (noun) – economic strain, monetary pressure, fiscal distress, money troubles, debt burden आर्थिक दबाव
18. **Money laundering** (noun) – the concealment of the origins of illegally obtained money, typically by means of transfers involving foreign banks or legitimate businesses. काले धन को वैध बनाना
19. **Tax evasion** (noun) – tax dodging, nonpayment, underreporting, illegal avoidance, concealment कर चोरी
20. **Against this backdrop** (phrase) – in this context, in light of this, amid these

conditions, considering this, against this context इसी पृष्ठभूमि में

21. **Seek** (verb) – aim for, pursue, strive for, endeavor to, look to प्रयास करना

22. **Flourish** (verb) – thrive, prosper, bloom, grow, expand फलना-फूलना

23. **Provision** (noun) – clause, stipulation, requirement, article, measure प्रावधान

24. **Facilitate** (verb) – enable, ease, assist, expedite, streamline सुगम बनाना

25. **In place** (phrase) – established, in effect, existing, operative, in force लागू

26. **Step in the right direction** (phrase) – positive move, welcome step, forward step, progress, right measure सही दिशा में कदम

27. **By no means** (phrase) – not at all, in no way, under no circumstances, far from, by no stretch कदापि नहीं

28. **Foolproof** (adjective) – reliable, fail-safe, airtight, watertight, infallible त्रुटिरहित

29. **Effectiveness** (noun) – efficacy, efficiency, potency, usefulness, impact प्रभावशीलता

30. **Impose** (verb) – enforce, levy, enact, institute, decree थोपना

31. **Blanket** (adjective) – sweeping, across-the-board, comprehensive, indiscriminate, all-encompassing समग्र

32. **Draw a line** (phrase) – set a boundary, differentiate, demarcate, set limits, make a distinction सीमा तय करना

33. **Moreover** (adverb) – besides, furthermore, additionally, also, what's more साथ ही

34. **Address** (verb) – tackle, deal with, confront, remedy, attend to समाधान करना

35. **Fall short of** (phrase) – fail to meet, be inadequate, miss the mark, be deficient, underdeliver कम पड़ना

36. **Rehabilitation** (noun) – recovery, de-addiction, reintegration, therapy, restoration पुनर्वास

37. **Mechanism** (noun) – system, framework, apparatus, process, arrangement तंत्र

38. **Prohibition** (noun) – ban, interdiction, proscription, forbiddance, outlawing निषेध

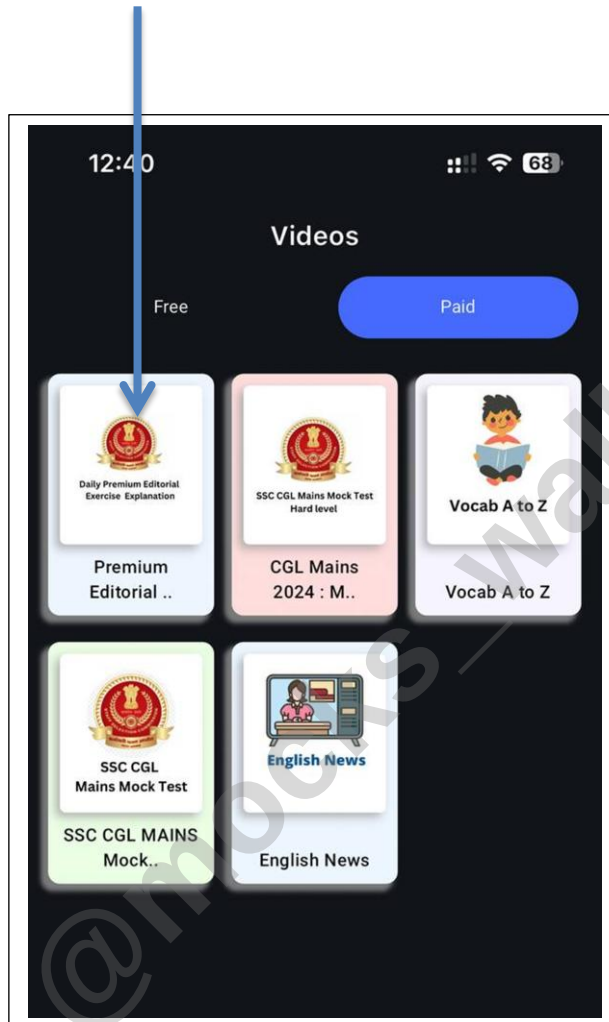
39. **Enforcement** (noun) – implementation, policing, execution, compliance monitoring, regulation प्रवर्तन

40. **Account for** (phrasal verb) – include, consider, explain, allow for, take into account सम्मिलित करना

41. **Emerging** (adjective) – nascent, evolving, upcoming, developing, new उभरता हुआ

42. **Well-intentioned** (adjective) – well-meaning, benevolent, good-faith, earnest, noble-minded नेकनीयत
43. **Vague** (adjective) – unclear, ambiguous, imprecise, nebulous, fuzzy अस्पष्ट
44. **Disruption** (noun) – disturbance, upheaval, breakdown, disorder, interruption बाधा
45. **Enforcement** (noun) – imposition, application, prosecution, sanctioning, law enforcement प्रवर्तन
46. **Way forward** (noun) – roadmap, path ahead, solution pathway, course of action, next steps आगे की राह
47. **Sweeping** (adjective) – broad, extensive, wholesale, far-reaching, across-the-board व्यापक
48. **Distinguish** (verb) – differentiate, discern, tell apart, set apart, demarcate भेद करना
49. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, many times अक्सर
50. **Norm** (noun) – standard, benchmark, criterion, rule, convention मानक
51. **Oversee** (verb) – supervise, monitor, superintend, administer, manage निगरानी करना
52. **Compliance** (noun) – adherence, conformity, observance, obedience, abidance अनुपालन
53. **Coordination** (noun) – harmonization, alignment, integration, cooperation, synchronization समन्वय

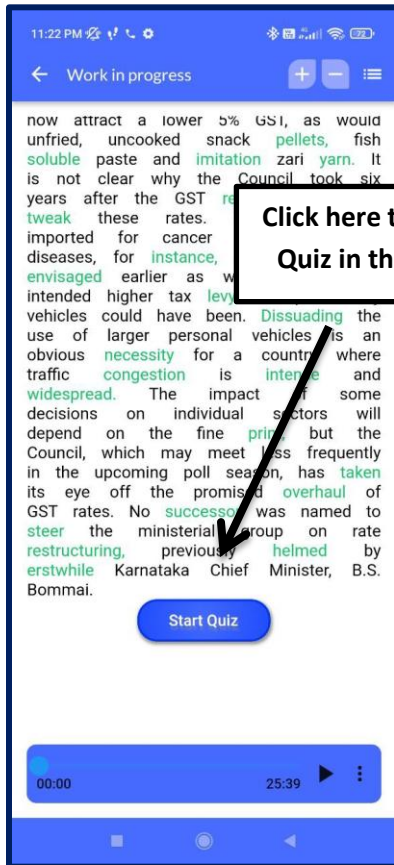
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



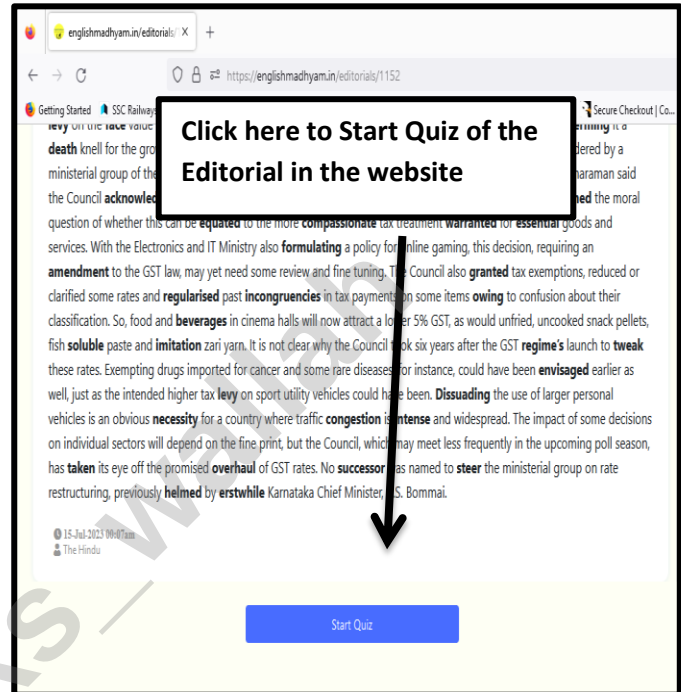
Summary of the Editorial

1. The government has finally acted to regulate online gaming sites after years of rising addiction and financial losses among youth.
2. Many individuals have lost lakhs of rupees, with some tragic cases of suicides and even self-immolation linked to gaming losses.
3. To address this, the Lok Sabha passed *"The Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Bill, 2025"*.
4. The Bill was presented by Union IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw and was cleared without debate.
5. It aims to balance encouraging e-sports, casual, and educational gaming while banning real-money gaming and betting.
6. India's online gaming sector has boomed due to cheap data, smartphones, and sports league popularity.
7. The industry is projected to reach \$3.6 billion by 2029.
8. Alongside growth, negative effects like addiction, financial ruin, money laundering, tax evasion, and even terror financing have surfaced.
9. The Bill seeks to provide a legal-regulatory framework that safeguards consumers while promoting safe digital gaming.
10. Key provisions include a ban on real-money gaming, with violations punishable by up to 3 years' jail and/or a ₹1 crore fine.
11. It also introduces advertising restrictions and financial controls for gaming platforms.
12. However, the Bill has loopholes, such as failing to differentiate between "games of skill" and "games of chance."
13. It lacks provisions for responsible gaming measures like age checks, spending caps, or rehabilitation support.
14. The Bill does not define a regulator's role for e-sports and ignores new tech like blockchain, NFTs, and metaverse gaming.
15. A more effective solution would be a balanced regulatory framework with clear definitions, licensing norms, and an independent regulator to ensure enforcement and coordination between Centre and states.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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